

SenaMUN V

SOCRATES' TRIAL



Serviço De Aprendizagem Comercial

Senac | Ensino Médio Técnico

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Welcome Letter

Hello fellow delegates, my name is Nayara and I will have the honor to be the Chair of Socrates' Trial Committee! My participation in the world of MUNs began in 2024 when I joined the debates Workshop at Senac and thus, participated in the third edition of SenaMUN as a delegate in ILO (International Labour Organization) committee. I have been in the world of debates actively since last half-year, yet the world of MUNs enchanted me and has taught me so many things that I carry within me in all areas of life.

We know the theme of this discussion can be challenging and intimidating at first, and by that statement, even though we are sure you all will exceed, we produced the document with care and intent to facilitate your research and comprehension of the topic.

I am an easy person to talk to, so, I hope my role is one of welcoming and complaisant in whatever you are unsure or need support. Please do not hesitate in contacting me if needed!

Kind regards and may the gods be with you,

Nayara A. de Lima (nayaraalvslima@gmail.com)

Hello lovers of justice and philosophy, how are you guys feeling? I hope pretty well, you'll call me Sthefany, one of your archons, my heart is beating in excitement 'n honor for being your chair!! This is so cool, I love philosophy and I hope you all too. This committee has everything to be the best of senamun's history so, can you take my hand and help me to turn this into our reality?

Philosophy is the art of questioning and Socrates told this to us, serving his life honoring this idea, the honor of liberty of opinion, even if you don't be in his side you can believe this, we can believe this so remember: In your life, the most important thinker is you, the most important ideas are the ones you have. Remember your rules and the gods will be on your side, the sun will rise more brightly and life will sound better.

The purpose of this committee is to challenge and encourage delegates to reflect how those who lived alongside Socrates — by chance, act like them — would respond in a situation where they exercise philosophical thinking, and decide about the future of the sacred knowledge, especially when face-to-face with the decision to condemn a man and his opinions.

I hope the sun follow you and all the graces run into you;

With love, your archon,

Sthefany da C. Moreira (sthefanycruz0666@gmail.com)

Hi! How are you guys doing? I hope you all are amazing. My name is Marina, I'll be one of your chairs in this amazing committee. I'm so excited for this MUN!! I'm looking forward to meeting you all. I'm sure that with this theme, we have everything to be the best committee of this all time in SenaMUN.

MUNs have become one of the best parts of my high school experience. I'm really glad that I found an environment where I identify so much and I'm so happy to be sharing this committee with you. I hope we can create a space where everyone feels comfortable speaking up, exchanging ideas, and having a great time. We will do everything we can for this experience to be unforgettable for you all!!

If you have any questions, concerns, or just want to talk about the committee, please don't hesitate about contacting me, feel free to reach out anytime. I'll be more than happy to help!

May Athena grant you wisdom,

Marina Carvalho Rosalem (mrosalem.academic@gmail.com)

1. Introduction to the Trial Committee

Figure 1 - Socrates' Address



Font - Lebrun (1867)

Ordinary Athenians—people who had to work for a living and did not belong to any of the aristocratic families—were proud of their democratic institutions and the freedoms they enjoyed, and they were well aware that their form of government had internal as well as external enemies and critics. Furthermore, they did not think of civic and religious matters as separate spheres but assumed instead that participation in the religious life of the city, as regulated by democratic institutions, was one of the duties of all citizens and that great harm could come to the city if the gods it recognized were offended or customary religious prohibitions were violated. (KRAUT, 2026).

Indeed there are impressive moments in human history, the most schemer of them, certainly, are when the pursuit of justice and truth are condemned for the irrational whim of men. In this committee, we will return to 399 BCE to discuss Socrates' Trial.

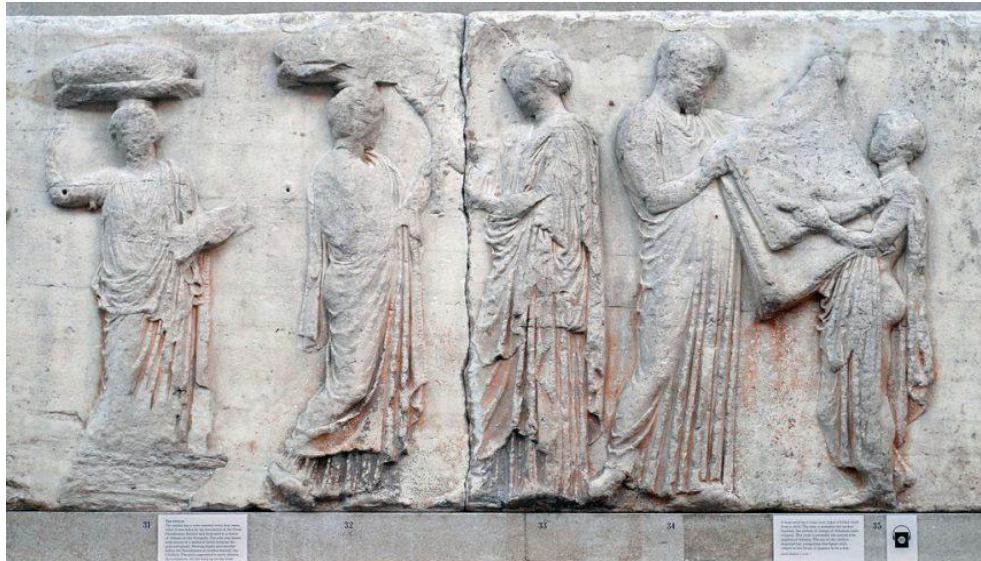
The council will operate under the Helieia - the most important legal system of the time - composed of 6,000 volunteer citizens, who from a raffle represented the judiciary; such a raffle process was made from the 'Kleroterion' to ensure that there were no bribes or intimidation against the jury. In fact, in these judgments, oral ability was the main element to persuade the jury. Due to the absence of lawyers, the participants themselves (accused, accusers and witnesses) presented their theses, common speeches with emotional and rhetorical appeal. Besides, under the 'Pericles' government the "remunerations" was established for those citizens with less financial means, granting their participation in the court and reassuring the Helieia was diverse.

Furthermore, for the outcome of the trial, the jury held a strict secret voting system, in which privacy was a must - conversations between jurors were prohibited, to avoid any bias. Accordingly, what the majority decided would be the final verdict. Thus, if the defendant was found guilty, the jury would enter into a process of analysis of the punishment estimated by the accuser and countered by the guilty.

In addition, it is important for the run of the Trial the polite and philosophical discussions throughout the entire committee. It is strongly recommended, appreciated and expected, regardless of the role taken by the fellow delegates, thereby reflecting the participation of Athenian citizenship.

2. Historical Context

Figure 2 - Greek population in frieze of the Parthenon.



Font: British Museum, 2024.

During the 5th to the 6th century b.C, Ancient Greece was going through moments of instability and conflict. The Peloponnesian War was caused by the dread of Sparta and allies by the imminent rise of Athens. The defeat of Athens resulted in the seizure of power by the Thirty Tyrants, installed by Sparta after its so-called win. Although it lasted a short amount of time, it was a tender wound after the return of Greek democracy. To begin with, Greek democracy was a social movement headed by the considered citizens - only the adult men born to Athenian fathers and mothers, who completed the military service. They would be in control of this society through the Agora - the central public square of the city-states, functioning as the beating heart of commercial, political, religious and social life. Besides, every citizen in the Agora has the same importance regardless of their social or political position.

Therefore, when democracy was restored the government insisted on an anistic system to avoid any kind of social nuisance. Nevertheless, in fragility it is common for new regimes, as well as the public sphere becoming less concise, or receptive to divergent ideas that question the costumes and values of the time. The maleducation of young elites by critical thinking was frowned upon, instead, governance needed total obedience to the traditions.

Moreover, people who did not respect the due deities were also seen as political threats. An example of this event was in 415 b.C, when before an expedition there were acts of vandalism

against the statue of the god Hermes - the protector of travelers. During the investigation of this incident, Alcibiadas (a Socrates follower) was accused of disrespect and treachery. Therefore, he was sent to face trial and most likely have his fate tied to death. So, he fled to the enemy city as a form to escape it, but failed to reintegrate in the Athenian society years later. Such instance represent only one of a number of several followers and admirers of Socrates who have been investigated by religious scandals.

From this perspective, the post-war instability indeed brought an interesting trait of human nature to the surface: the desire to find a common cause for the downfall, in this case, of a city-state in its golden age.

There was in Athens, particularly among the well-born, wealthy, and young, a degree of admiration for certain aspects of Spartan life and government. These young men, who spent much of their time in the public gymnasia, prided themselves on their toughness, practiced a certain simplicity of style, and grew their hair long—all in imitation of Spartan ways. (As Plato and Xenophon confirm, Socrates himself shared some of these qualities.) (KRAUT, 2026).

The allegations that led to the trial were based on Socrates' antidemocratic ideas, the hatred upon him, and his supposed relations to others considered antidemocratic traitors. So, Socrates was well aware that he was a loathing figure - having poor financial means, no political privilege, and a stranger to his own family, given that his attention was mainly to the public sphere, in which now was persecuting him. In Socrates' perspective, his image and intentions were misinterpreted long ago. Starting in “Clouds”, an Aristophanes comedy play, where the character named Socrates - a principal of the school - investigates the real-world observation to deny the existence of any deities, and study the language to use the rhetorical devices to “make the worse into the stronger argument”, dated in Socrates’ of the Apology. Also portrayed in the play, a father and son, respectively Strepsiades and Pheidippides, attend Socrates’ school, and in the end, the son uses argumentative skills to prove that a son has the right to outdo the parents. As the play’s conclusion: Strepsiades denounces Socrates and burns his building.

It is an inquiry: “why did Aristophanes write such a play?” Perhaps, to reflect the citizens' frustrations or, simply, because the figure was familiar to his audience. Indeed, long before this play, Socrates had a reputation for spending his days exposing the fellow citizens, questioning their so-called possessed knowledge and coming to the conclusion that: beyond failing to actually know what they claim to know, they got offended by this fact pointed out, thus hating the philosopher.

Matter of fact, the only public who engaged properly with his debates were the young and wealthy ones, who spent their days with him, and later on, doing the same questioning to the elders, by that justifying, why the greater power was convinced that Socrates was corrupting the youngers of the city.

Through the accusation of being responsible for the corruption of the young, Socrates presented in his court that those who show hatred for him feel it from the frustration of not knowing how to answer his questions, of feeling foolish towards young people. They would not admit that their inferiority was a problem, but rather blame the “threat that the philosopher poses by causing doubts in younger generations about religious traditions”. However, this rhetorical argument brought some figures, such as Meletus, to come to court against him, and also made it difficult for the members of the public jury to accept the arguments presented by Socrates. He believed that the reason the government made him face trial is a reflection of the people diverted from the need to give satisfaction of their lives and understandings. According to him, they resist self-examination, and judge those who point out that it should be done, and indeed, properly done.

Subsequently, it is clear that Socrates’ was a threat to the system, since he openly exposes his antidemocratic ideas. According to the philosopher, the majority hated being contradicted in discussions, and they will always prevent it from happening. Moreover, he even praised his public to withdraw from political life, since a great person who fights for justice of the good would never be alive in democracy. Socrates implies that the democratic system was a naturally corrupt system, also from his experiences, he understood that most people were satisfied with shallow knowledge of deep social issues, and when they are given great political power, it inevitably turns into injustice.

The leader of the most extreme wing of this group, Critias, was part of the Socratic circle; so, too, was Charmides, another of the 30. The democrats, many of whom had left Athens when the 30 came to power, defeated them in battle, and democracy was restored the following year. (In Plato’s *Apology*, Socrates refers to the reign of the 30 and their unsuccessful attempt to implicate him in their crimes. (KRAUT, 2026).

In Plato’s *Apology*, Socrates was associated as the teacher of those who posed a threat to democracy, such as Critias, one of the Thirty Tyrants that had seized the government. However, Socrates claimed that he was not in the role of teaching, meaning he could not have any students, even though in his perspective the concept of democracy was based in popular ignorance, mainly on critical thinking, and therefore there was the need to educate. Furthermore, he believed that the governor should have, beyond popularity among citizens, governance skills and the ability to be

authority. He questioned the voting capacity of citizens, as well as the governmental capacity of those who were elected.

3. Background Information

Figure 3 - Athenians voted for Socrates to be put to death



Font: Jacques Louis David, 1931.

3.1. Peloponnesian War

Opening the list of the most relevant events in Athenian history, the Peloponnesian War stands as one of the most catastrophic and intellectually significant conflicts of the ancient world. Beneath the surface of the war some significant names emerged, and with them, the philosophical analysis of conflicts. An opportunity for a point of view who scrutinized the real justice in the hawkish events that vividly colored Athens with red. Between the names it's possible to remember Pericles, Alcibiades and narrators like Thucydides.

Bringing the war into the center of discussion, the main conflict was between Sparta and Athens. Sparta, an Oligarchy¹ austere system. Athens, the mother of democracy. The Athenian arm extended to the island and coastal states with most parts of the Aegean Sea by hand. In the opposite position, Sparta was the Leader of an Alliance of Independent States that included some parts of the most relevant powers in the Peloponnese and Central State Greece. Likewise, Athens had the strongest Navy while Sparta had the biggest army; moreover, Athens received regular tributes from the empire for upcoming wars, becoming a financially more prepared state than its enemies.

By the intention of describing the war, it's important to have clear the act of some special events like the Battle of Pylos who's happened besides 425 BCE. Called Pylos or Navarino, stands in the far southwestern quadrant of the Peloponnesus one of the scenarios of the previously said war. Started with the Athenian fleet, initially commanded by the orders of Eurymedon and Sophocles, who's driven ashore by a storm leading Demosthenes, an advisor aboard the fleet to fortify the Pylos peninsula. The Battle counted with approximately 600 men, including 90 hoplites being Demosthenes imbued by the mission of impeding the Spartan Assault. Commanded by King Agis, the Spartan forces comprised 43 triremes⁵ and a considerable land army. Preventing the Spartan attack at the weakest point of his defenses, Demosthenes positioned his forces accordingly, launching simultaneous assaults from both land and sea. But, the Battle just lasted about one and a half of fierce fighting having to shift a siege strategy which made it unable to breach the Athenian fortifications.

With the Spartan siege underway - a circumstance that further highlighted Athens' superior financial organization and naval mobility - an Athenian fleet of fifty triremes arrived from Zacynthus, dramatically altering the balance of the conflict. The reinforcements succeeded in defeating the Spartan fleet and securing control of the surrounding waters, effectively isolating a contingent of Spartan soldiers on the nearby island of Sphacteria. What followed was one of the most remarkable episodes of the war: the eventual surrender of Spartan hoplites, an event previously thought almost unimaginable in the Greek world. The outcome of the Battle of Pylos not only represented a significant military triumph for Athens, but also exposed the vulnerabilities of Sparta's seemingly invincible military reputation, reshaping the strategic and political landscape of the Peloponnesian War. The Peace of Nicias, signed in 421 BCE, failed to bring a lasting end to the Peloponnesian War. Within only a few years, ambitious Athenian leaders turned their attention toward Sicily, where they sought new opportunities for expansion. Syracuse, the most powerful city on the island and an important source of grain for Sparta's allies, became the primary target of Athenian ambitions.

In 415 BCE, Athens launched the Sicilian Expedition, one of the largest military operations in its history. Many Athenians believed that the conquest of Syracuse would secure control over Sicily and provide the wealth, resources, and strategic advantage necessary to achieve final victory over Sparta. The expedition departed with an impressive force, including over one hundred triremes, thousands of hoplite soldiers, and numerous support vessels.

Despite its strength, however, the campaign quickly encountered difficulties. Under the command of Nicias, who had originally opposed the expedition, the Athenians failed to exploit their early advantages and instead became entangled in a prolonged siege of Syracuse. As the conflict dragged on, Sparta and allies sent reinforcements to assist the Syracusans, transforming the campaign into a costly struggle on both land and sea.

Athens repeatedly dispatched additional troops and ships in an attempt to break the stalemate, but these efforts proved unsuccessful. By 413 BCE, the balance of power had shifted decisively in favor of Syracuse and its allies. The Athenian fleet became trapped within the harbor, where a series of devastating naval engagements resulted in the destruction of nearly all remaining ships. Facing disaster, the Athenian army attempted a retreat overland, abandoning many sick and wounded soldiers. The withdrawal ended in catastrophe: the army was surrounded, defeated, and forced to surrender. Nicias was executed, while thousands of survivors were captured and sold into slavery.

The defeat of the Sicilian Expedition stands as one of the most disastrous military failures in ancient history. Athens lost tens of thousands of men, a substantial portion of its fleet, and much of the prestige it had accumulated throughout the fifth century BCE. Although the city continued to fight Sparta for several more years, the catastrophe in Sicily marked a turning point in the war and severely weakened Athens' ability to maintain its position as the dominant power in the Greek world.

The Battle of Aegospotami, fought in 405 BCE, marked the decisive conclusion of the Peloponnesian War and secured Sparta's ultimate victory over Athens. Taking place in the Hellespont, the battle followed several days during which the opposing fleets observed one another without engaging in combat. On the fifth day, however, the Spartan commander Lysander, seized an unexpected opportunity and launched a surprise attack against the Athenian fleet while it was anchored near Aegospotami.

The assault proved devastating. Caught unprepared, the Athenians were unable to organize an effective defense, and the vast majority of their fleet was destroyed or captured. Of approximately 180 Athenian ships, only a small number managed to escape under the command of Conon. Thousands of Athenian sailors and soldiers fell into Spartan hands, many of whom were subsequently executed.

The defeat at Aegospotami shattered Athens' naval power, which had long been the foundation of its empire and military strength. With the Athenian fleet effectively eliminated, Lysander was able to advance against Athens itself, cutting off vital supplies and tightening Spartan

control over the region. Isolated and unable to continue the war, Athens was forced to surrender in 404 BCE, bringing an end to nearly three decades of conflict and inaugurating a new era of Spartan dominance in the Greek world.

3.2. The Athenian Plague

The Plague emerged in 430 BCE until 427 BCE, during the second year of the Peloponnesian war. It's possible to say that the whole event was a biological catastrophe and a named deep moral crisis for Athens. With the city's focus being against Sparta and thousands of citizens marching from the countryside crowded behind the Athenian walls, the idea of a builded way of protection turned into confinement very soon. In the heat, noise, and density of the city, the disease moved faster than reason, turning Athens — once celebrated for its philosophy, democracy, and artistic brilliance — into a place consumed by fear and decay.

Thucydides would describe the “Plague” with an unusual precision and emotional restraint, remaining one of the earliest attempts of a scientific observation of a disease, diverging of the mythological path that was quite common at this time. The main symptoms observed ranged from a violent fever, skin eruptions to vomiting, which would commonly lead to death. Athens was weakened, not only by the war but also by the epidemic that swept through the streets, taking the lives of Athenians with it; many victims died within days. Physicians, unable to understand the illness, often perished beside their patients, while religious rituals and prayers appeared powerless against the spreading death. Through Thucydides' writing, the plague becomes more than a medical event; it reveals the fragile boundary between civilization and chaos.

It is pretty important to remember, as mortality increased, the social structure of Athens began to fracture. In this period laws lost authority, funeral traditions collapsed and citizens abandoned all moral restraint believing that life had to become unpredictable and temporary, all the wealth, honor and social status suddenly seemed insignificant when faced with death. This situation was one of many that would narrate the decline of humanity in Athens. The plague exposed how quickly human order can dissolve when confronted with suffering, sickness and death, in a way which cannot be controlled or explained. Even those who bore medals and honor on their chests would not be able to control the nature of death, pain, and sorrow. For example, Pericles, the statesman, face of the Athenian Golden Age, eventually died from the epidemic symbolizing the last straw of the city's weakening.

3.3. Athenian Defeat

After its defeat in the seas, Athens entered a phase of difficulties, losing its walls and conquered lands. Its navy disintegrated, the end of the Delian League, thus no longer standing in the economic center of Ancient Greece. In unfortunate addition, the Spartan empire imposed an oligarchic government¹ called the Thirty Tyrants.

Furthermore, the regime is composed of extremely conservative thirty two magistrates, led by Critias - that Socrates supposedly had associations with - to produce a new oligarchic constitution and ensure that the Athenians would not re-establish democracy. The growing admiration among the more fortunate citizens for the Spartan system of government, which contradicted the democratic ideals of the most humble, contributed to political and popular instability and facilitated the imposition of oligarchic politics on the territory. During this government, there were abolition of public courts, confiscation of properties, execution of democrats or anyone considered a threat, causing the death of about 1.500 Athenians. The social impact of the Thirty Tyrants rule was marked by oppression, exile and executions, spreading terror and instability throughout the region.

However, those who were exiled for having fewer extremist political perspectives created strategies and forces to seize power and finally restore democracy. Most honorable: Thrasybulus, an exiled general in 404 b.C who began to gather a group of men, meaning to approach Athens. As soon as he got more collaboration, the attacks of the tyrants were avoided, and later, the democracy was restored. Thrasybulus, then, was considered a hero of the nation for the role he played in this historical milestone for the Athenian population.

Subsequently to the reintegration of the democratic system, the city-state re-established and solidified its idealistic foundations. It created a legal framework conceptually consistent, accessible and differentiating from the absolute government of tyrants, theoretically more humane. Moreover, it indeed reinforced the citizens' participation in politics, confirming how important the involvement of the popular view in public government spheres was. Thus, the code remained the basis of Athenian law until the end the fifth century b.C This post-tyrannical reform became sorely needed mainly to restore harmony and order, ensuring that democracy was restored as a fairer system. Therefore, there were policies to warrant the government was not threatened again, the fate of those

in the previous power was secured by execution during the conflicts, but thereafter, amnesty was granted to supporters of the Tyrants, claiming they were not criminals.

3.4. Cultural and Intellectual Crises

Standing at life's crossroads, between glory and uncertainty, was Athens, sitting in the middle of the scenario. Once the brilliant center of the Greek ancient world, the city-state was in a position of pain and a recent recovery process from the wounds left by the Peloponnesian War. Its empire had crumbled, its confidence had been shaken, and its citizens were clearly weakened, finding themselves searching for stability in the aftermath of defeat and political turmoil. The brief but brutal rule of the Thirty Tyrants had left deep scars on the collective memory of the polis, while the recently restored democracy struggled to reaffirm its authority.

Yet, amidst this atmosphere of barren anxiety, Athens remained, in its way, a city with lived ideas. The streets, agoras and all the public spaces echoed voices of justice, virtue, knowledge and a fragile seek for the nature of itself. Philosophers challenged conventions when sophists were teaching about persuasion, playwrights being the reason for the smile of the common people rather than the satires of public figures, all in the place where citizens took pride in their participation in civic life. It was an age in which intellectual curiosity flourished, but also one in which old certainties were increasingly called into question.

At the heart of this vibrant yet fragile society stood Socrates, a man who possessed no office, commanded no army, and wrote no books, and whose questions unsettled some of the most powerful assumptions of his time. By urging Athenians to examine their beliefs and confront their own ignorance, he became admired and feared. To some, he embodied the pursuit of wisdom; to others, he represented a dangerous challenge to tradition, authority, and social order.

Thus, the trial of Socrates unfolded against a backdrop of political insecurity, cultural transformation, and intellectual ferment. It was more than the prosecution of a single philosopher - it was a reflection of a city wrestling with its identity, caught between the preservation of its traditions and the unsettling possibilities of critical thought.

On complete analyses, it is clear that Socrates, constantly positioning himself against the democratic system, would become a public problem among the downfall of Athens. Socrates' trial took place in 399 BC, considered a historical moment to understand the nature of freedom of speech,

in contrast with laws and morality.

4. Current Situation

The trial and condemnation of Socrates operates under consecutive calamities that passed through Athens. The plague decimated the Athenian population, the defeat in the Peloponnesian War following the imposition of a tyrannical government that slaughtered more than a thousand citizens. The climate that surrounds the polis is full of paranoia and concern. Even with democracy being restored, even with amnesty decreed, resentment was more present than stability.

Distinguishing Socrates from those blessed by amnesty, there was a loophole in the amnesty law used to arouse accusations against the philosopher: the law spared those with political and blood crimes during tyranny, while Socrates had a reputation: corrupting the democratic ideals of the youthful population, posing himself as a direct and constant threat in the continuation of such a governmental system. Moreover, despite the existing and active law, the population held bitterness from the philosopher; this same population is the jury that would vote under Socrates' life. The government would not be favorable for the philosopher to preserve himself, while openly disagreeing with its political operation. This is a clear example of the moments when knowledge was underestimated or treated like an obstacle to progress.

It was a political necessity to find culpability on something - or someone - for the ruin of the city. The controversial image the philosopher held ensured that the paranoia and constant search for traitors would get results, even if forced. In the preceding to the court, it was tangibly felt that the recently restored democracy could collapse with any threats of internal questioning and dissent about the government and its gods, hence Socrates' formal accusation.

The process for bringing Socrates to the tribunal was structured from the proceeding of the time. First, the accusers would show their arguments. More specifically, Lincon who represented the rhetoric, Anito who represented politics, and Meleto, Socrates' main accuser, who represented the poets. The three figures represented a sphere of Athenian society that had been affected by the philosopher's questioning. They would present their formal complaint (graphe) to the magistrates.

Meletus, Son of Meletus, de Pitus, against Socrates, Son of Sophroniscus, de Allopeca. Socrates is guilty of not recognizing the gods that the city recognizes and introducing new deities; he is also guilty of corrupting youth. The proposed penalty: death. (Laércio, 2008, p. 55).

Before the tribune, the magistrates held an anakrisis (an introductory hearings). At this step, the magistrate inquire the accusers and the accused to ensure that the argument had legal basis and jurisdiction of the courts. Concluding with the presentation of the future trial to the further citizens.

Following the stages previously outlined, the moment of the trial is reached.

5. Overall stance of the key members

The trial of Socrates differs significantly from the traditional United Nations committee, the delegates should interpret philosophical alignments, and political objectives throughout the debate. Rather than representing modern nation-states, the participants will embody historical figures and social groups whose perspectives were shaped by the intellectual, religious, and political tensions of Classical Athens — To reiterate, it's important that the delegations act like their characters to enrich the immersion system.

5.1. Stances presented in debate

The following overall stance of the key members is responsible for providing a general understanding of the principal factions present within the committee. While these groupings reflect historical tendencies and likely alliances, they should not be interpreted as rigid or permanent. The delegates are encouraged to challenge assumptions, negotiate across factional lines, and develop positions that remain dependably with their assigned character's beliefs, interests, and historical context. As in the original trial, loyalties may shift, alliances may fracture, and the outcome will ultimately depend on the strength of the arguments presented before the court. By that statement, the committee will be made from three main blocks, which are the Traditional and Prosecution Bloc, the Socratic and Reform Bloc and the Independent Intellectuals and Pragmatists Bloc. Therefore, the proper presentation of the blocks needs to be initiated.

5.2. Traditionalist and Prosecution Bloc

Firstly, the Traditionalist and Prosecution Bloc. This bloc will support the safeguard of the Athenian way of life, bring the traditions, religious values and political stability. These members are, generally, inclined to support the accusations against Socrates. This bloc should argue against Socrates and his allies, talk about preserving the social and political order.

Included delegates:

Anytus (ἄνυτος) General of the Peloponnesian War	A prominent wealthy Athenian politician (After 403 BCE he was a respected, moderate leader of the restored democracy) and one of Socrates' principal accusers. His prosecution of Socrates for impiety was probably motivated less by
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	religious concerns than by anger at Socrates' disdain for democratic politicians improving the vox populi to question more of these ones.
Meletus (Μέλητος) Citizen of Athens and a poet	The formal prosecutor in the trial against Socrates <i>Id est</i> was responsible for initializing the accusations. He is best known for bringing charges of impiety (Not recognizing the local gods) and corruption of the youth. It sprung either from his religious fanaticism or his anger over Socrates' association with the Thirty Tyrants.
Lycon (λύκος) Prosecutor in the trial of Socrates	One of the accusers of Socrates, representing the interests of Athenian rhetoricians and public speakers. He is described as "an orator," another profession Socrates held in especially low regard.
Aristophanes (Ἀριστοφάνης) Greek Playwright	A celebrated comic playwright who satirized Socrates in “The Clouds”. His portrayal contributed to the philosopher's controversial public image.
Oligarchy Sympathizers Council	Despite sharing Socrates' disdain for democracy, they are inclined to support the accusations, as they view his philosophy as a direct threat to oligarchic rule. They cannot tolerate his insistence that only the truly wise, rather than the wealthy or noble-born, are fit to govern, seeing his critiques as a danger to the traditional authority of the elite.
Oracle of Delphi Priestess, Pythia (Πυθία)	The priestess who delivers Apollo's prophecies

	at Delphi. Her famous declaration that no one was wiser than Socrates played a crucial role in shaping his philosophical mission.
Representative of the Members of the Boule Member of the Council of 500	As the voice of institutional order and democratic legality in Athens, he ensures that the process takes place rigidly within the laws of the polis. He maintains a deep distrust towards Socrates.

5.3. Socratic and Philosophical Reform Bloc

The second bloc to be presented is the Socratic and Philosophical Reform Bloc. This bloc will primarily advocate about the intellectual freedom, philosophical inquiry and the fullfaced defense of Socrates.

Included delegates:

Socrates (Σωκράτης) Greek philosopher, the accused	A renowned Athenian philosopher known for encouraging critical thinking through questioning and dialogue. He is accused of impiety and corrupting the youth of Athens, becoming the central figure of the trial.
Plato (Πλάτων) Socrates apprentice	One of Socrates' most famous students. Plato admired Socrates deeply and later documented many of his ideas through philosophical dialogues.
Xenophon (Ξενοφών) Historian, philosopher and strategos	He defended Socrates' Trial as a blatant injustice, that in truth, the philosopher was beneficial to Athens. He argumented in his work that the philosopher preferred death given by the deities, rather than life in the weakness

	of old age.
Antisthenes (Ἀντισθένης) Athenian philosopher	A devoted follower of Socrates and founder of the Cynic school of philosophy. He emphasized virtue, self-discipline, and independence from material wealth.
Alexandros (Ἀλέξανδρος) Representation of the young age	The representation of the younger generation of Athens. He is opposed to the accusation that Socrates corrupted the youth and offers virtuous perspectives on his real influence.

5.4. Independent Intellectuals and Pragmatist Bloc

The last bloc is the Independent Intellectuals and Pragmatists Bloc. This bloc contains delegates whose positions may shift throughout the debate. They are more interested in rhetoric, logic, political consequences, and practical outcomes than in unconditional support for either side.

Included delegates:

Gorgias (Γοργίας) Greek sophist	One of the most influential Sophists in ancient Greece. He emphasized rhetoric and persuasive speech as essential tools in political life.
Hippias (Ἱππίας) The tyrant of Athens	A Sophist recognized for his vast knowledge across multiple fields. He advocated intellectual self-sufficiency and practical education.
Prodicus (Πρόδικος) Greek sophist	A Sophist known for his careful analysis of language and the precise meaning of words.
Protagoras (Πρωταγόρας) Greek sophist	One of the most famous Sophists, remembered for the statement, "Man is the measure of all things." He emphasized relativism and human-centered knowledge.

Thrasymachus (Θρασύμαχος) Greek sophist	A sophist and rhetorician known for his argument that justice often serves the interests of the powerful.
Thucydides (Θουκυδίδης) The writer of “History of the Peloponnesian War”	Historian and author of The History of the Peloponnesian War. He focused on political realism and the practical consequences of human actions.
Democritus (Δημόκριτος) Pre-socratic philosopher, formulator an atomic theory of the universe	A philosopher best known for developing an early atomic theory of matter. He valued rational inquiry and observation.
Alcibiades (Ἀλκιβιάδης) Statesman and Athenian General	A brilliant but controversial statesman and military leader. Once associated with Socrates, his political actions were often cited by critics as evidence of Socrates' negative influence.

6. Delegations List

DELEGATION	ROLE
Alcibiades	Heliast
Anytus	Accuser
Antisthenes	Heliast
Lycon	Accuser
Meletus	Accuser
Socrates	Accused
Thrasymachus	Heliast
Xenophon	Heliast
Aristophanes	Heliast
Thucydides	Heliast
Democritus	Heliast
Gorgias	Heliast
Hippias	Heliast
Oligarchy Sympathizers Council	Heliast
Plato	Heliast
Prodicus	Heliast
Protagoras	Heliast
Representant of the Members of the Boule	Heliast
Oracle of Delphi Priest, Pitia	Heliast
Alexandros	Heliast

7. Glossary

AEGEAN SEA - The sea located between Greece and contemporary Turkey. It played a central role in the development of Greek trade and naval power.

AGORA - The main public space that existed in ancient Greek city-states. It was used for social interactions, commercial and political activities, as well as public debate.

ANAKRISIS - A preliminary judicial step in ancient Athens in which magistrates would examine the facts and arguments of a case, collect evidence, and decide whether it should or not proceed to the trial.

BOULE - A deliberative council of citizens appointed to run the daily administrative affairs of a polis. The citizens were chosen by lottery.

DELIAN LEAGUE - An alliance of Greek city-states led by Athens. Established in 478 BCE after the Persian War to prevent future Persian threats.

DELPHI - The most important sacred religious sanctuary in ancient Greece, located on the slopes of Mount Parnassus it was considered the epicenter of spiritual guidance for the entire Mediterranean.

DEMOSTHENES - An Athenian statesman (384-322 BCE). Known for his speeches advocating resistance against the expansions of Macedonia Power.

GRAPHE - A legal action that any citizen could be concerning offenses considered harmful to the community of the state.

HELIAIA - The main popular court in ancient Athens, composed of juries randomly selected.

KLEROTERION - The device used to randomly select eligible citizens for the jury service. The purpose was to ensure fairness and reduce corruption.

OLIGARCHY - A government that consists of political and economic power concentrated in a small and specific group of people, usually families or elites, selfishly overlooking the population, but focusing on the well-being of the members themselves. The words etymology: “oligos” (little), “arkh” (government), “government of few”.

STRATEGOS - The army leader or general. The word comes from “stratos” (army) and “agos” (leader), “army leader”.

TRIEMES - Warships powered by sails and three tiers of rowers. They were the base of the Athenian naval strength at that time.

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